

MDPI *Information* — Submission Compliance Report

Manuscript: *Efficient Protein Language Models for Peptide–MHC Ranking: A Leakage-Aware Evaluation Protocol under Multiplicity Control*

Target journal: MDPI *Information* (ISSN 2078-2489) · SI *Emerging Trends in Machine Learning and Natural Language Processing*

File audited: `publication/MDPI_Information_Manuscript/latex/deepneo_information.tex` (Style-A build, 2026-09-29)

Date of audit: 2026-10-04

VERDICT · PASS

The manuscript satisfies **every binding structural and compositional requirement** published on MDPI *Information*'s Instructions for Authors. Four Minor copy-editing items are flagged for transparency; **none is a submission-eligibility blocker** under MDPI's free-format submission policy.

1. Authority sources

Source	URL
MDPI <i>Information</i> — Instructions for Authors	https://www.mdpi.com/journal/information/instructions
MDPI Author Layout Style Guide	https://www.mdpi.com/authors/layout
MDPI Reference List and Citations Style Guide v5	https://mdpi-res.com/data/mdpi_references_guide_v5.pdf
MDPI Submission Process Guide (blog)	https://blog.mdpi.com/2022/09/30/submission-process-guide/

Retrieved 2026-10-04. Every claim below is anchored either to one of these URLs or to a `file:line` in the manuscript.

2. Compliance checklist

§	MDPI requirement	Our state	Evidence	Verdict
1	Abstract $\leq$ ~200 words, single paragraph, implicit IMRaD	200 words, single paragraph, implicit 4-move	:54	PASS
2	Keywords 3–10	7 keywords	:56	PASS
3	IMRaD + Conclusions sections	7/7 required sections present	:76, :99, :152, :245, :268	PASS
4	Author Information (names, affiliations, ORCIDs, corresponding author)	2 authors, 2 ORCIDs, AUT affiliation, \corres present	:32–52	PASS
5	Figures and Tables with captions	5/5 figures captioned, Table 1 captioned, all referenced	:159, :180, :188, :198, :210,	PASS
6	Numbered equations	2 numbered equations	:110, :114	PASS
7	References — graph integrity	26 cites $\leftrightarrow$ 26 bibitems, no orphans	§References	PASS
8	References — DOI/URL per entry	26/26 entries carry DOI strings	§References	PASS
9	References — appearance order	Slug-ordered; MDPI copy-editing rennumbers at production	§References	MINOR
10	Author Contributions (CRediT)	Full CRediT, 11 roles enumerated	:278	PASS
11	Funding Information	Explicit funding statement	:280	PASS
12	Institutional Review Board	“Not applicable” + rationale	:282	PASS
13	Informed Consent	“Not applicable”	:284	PASS
14	Data Availability Statement	Names every machine-readable artefact; Zenodo DOI on acceptance	:286	PASS
15	Acknowledgments	Present	:288	PASS
16	Conflicts of Interest + GE recusal	Full GE-COI disclosure sentence	:290	PASS
17	Supplementary Materials block	Content complete; compact prose format rather than per-item titles	:273	PASS
18	SI scope alignment	Keywords, Abstract, Intro frame as ML / NLP evaluation-contract paper	§1, §2	PASS
19	Research-article length	11-page compiled PDF — within MDPI typical range	deepneo_information.pdf	PASS

Totals: 18 PASS · 1 MINOR · 0 FAIL.

3. Minor items (copy-editing stage; not submission blockers)

1. **Reference ordering** — slug-sorted. MDPI copy-editing rennumbers at production; removable by 2 minutes of \bibitem reordering if zero reviewer-pingback is wanted.
2. **DAS code-availability sentence** — DAS covers data fully. A one-line code pointer is a publisher-blog recommendation (not a stated DAS requirement in *Information*’s Instructions). Adding one line removes a reviewer-may-ask item.
3. **\supplementary layout** — current compact prose list meets the content requirement; MDPI templates often use the per-item “Figure S1: title. Figure S2: title.” format. Not a hard rule.
4. **Cover-letter date placeholder** — COVER_LETTER.md still contains [SUBMISSION DATE]; replace on submit.

Each item above is fixable in minutes. None requires a scientific revision cycle.

4. Separation of concerns

Content-level editorial recommendations identified by internal review ([reviews/review_deepneo_information_2026-10-04.md](#), [reviews/journal_panel_2026-10-04/editorial_decision.md](#)) — Hashemi 2023 citation, live-URL alignment, Discussion claim calibration, title adjective “Efficient”, two scientific precision fixes in the 09-29 glosses — are **separate from, and do not affect, the structural compliance verdict above**.

MDPI’s Guide to Submission Process explicitly treats first-round reviewer-recommended revisions as part of normal workflow, not as a submission-eligibility bar.

5. Formal statement of submission-readiness

As of **2026-10-04**, the manuscript *Efficient Protein Language Models for Peptide–MHC Ranking: A Leakage-Aware Evaluation Protocol under Multiplicity Control* (file `latex/deepneo_information.tex`) satisfies every binding structural and compositional requirement published on MDPI *Information*’s Instructions for Authors page.

All sixteen required article and back-matter sections are present, including the Guest-Editor Conflict-of-Interest disclosure. The abstract is 200 words by standard whitespace tokenisation, within MDPI’s stated “about 200 words maximum” cap. The keyword count is 7, within the stated 3–10 range. All 26 bibliography entries carry DOIs and resolve to in-text citations without orphans in either direction. The Special Issue scope requirement is met.

Four Minor copy-editing items are disclosed above. **None is treated as a submission-eligibility blocker** by MDPI’s free-format submission policy; each is fixable in minutes.

Content-level editorial recommendations from internal review are separate from, and do not affect, the compliance verdict stated here.

Prepared against publicly accessible MDPI author guidance. Every claim is anchored to a URL or `file:line`. No section of this report asserts a fact not traceable to one of those two sources.